

Agency Revolution vs Levitate: engineering-grade teardown

This teardown reconstructs both platforms at the feature, data, and system level so a product + engineering team can design a superior successor. **Agency Revolution (AR, owned by FMG Suite)** is a deep, AMS-integrated marketing automation engine built around linear sequences, pre-built insurance campaigns, and an "Outbox" approval gate. **Levitate** is a relationship-marketing/CRM-lite platform that sends personal-feeling emails from the user's own Gmail/Outlook mailbox, anchored by a "Keep in Touch" reminder system and an AI assistant ("Lev"). AR wins on automation depth, AMS trigger surface, and insurance-specific campaign library. Levitate wins on deliverability-by-design, personal tone, AI assistance, and cross-vertical reach. Both have material gaps in analytics depth, revenue/policy attribution, branching workflow logic, and A/B testing. Where exact specs are not publicly documented, assumptions are flagged ([INFERRED]).

1. System overview

1.1 Product philosophy

Agency Revolution positions as an "**insurance marketing automation + client engagement**" platform that sits on top of the AMS. Its thesis: agencies retain more clients when AMS policy events (renewal, rate change, new policy, lost policy) automatically drive multi-channel, approval-gated communications. AR explicitly is **not a CRM and not an AMS**; it mirrors AMS data and layers orchestration, content, and analytics on top. Customer-facing retention claims ("94% retention," "\$3M attributable revenue at Renaissance") frame the value in **retention lift and staff hours saved** rather than acquisition. (agencyrevolution + 2)

Levitate positions as a "**relationship marketing / Happiness Platform**" ("Keep in Touch") — the anti-blast. Core thesis: mass email is losing deliverability and trust; what wins is personal-feeling outreach sent from the producer's own inbox on a reliable cadence.

Levitate is **CRM-lite** (lightweight contact DB + cadence reminders + AI content) rather than a replacement AMS or a full marketing automation suite. It positions across several relationship-heavy verticals — insurance, wealth management, legal, accounting, nonprofit — and treats insurance as the lead vertical. [PR Newswire + 2](#)

Net positioning difference: **AR = heavy automation engine wired to AMS events; Levitate = lightweight relationship cadence wired to the user's inbox plus AI.**

1.2 Core modules

Module	Agency Revolution	Levitate
Email marketing	Fuse: block-based WYSIWYG, AI rewrite, multi-location senders, Outbox approval	Personal plain-text style (primary) + HTML Newsletter tab (2025+); sent via user's OAuth'd mailbox
SMS marketing	Business Texting add-on: 1:1 + bulk, two-way inbox, 10DLC-managed	1:1 + text campaigns (each sent singly), two-way, MMS ≤3.5MB, 10DLC required Levitate
CRM / contact system	Account → Contact → Policy mirror of AMS; tags, segments, Pipeline, notes	Contact-centric with tags, Key Facts, Keep-in-Touch intervals, Policy Boards
Automation engine	Campaign → Sequence → Step (linear, not a visual canvas); Trigger Points + segments	Multi-step automations with date/tag/event triggers; YOLO auto-mode; per-segment branching
Campaign library	100+ prebuilt insurance campaigns Agencysagent (renewal, cross-sell, NPS, holiday, etc.)	Monthly curated insurance content, 4 custom templates/year, pre-built relationship automations

Module	Agency Revolution	Levitate
Reporting	Dashboard, NPS, Business Insights (book of business), Marketing Calendar	Dashboard cards, open/click/reply tracking, Client Happiness Score™, QuickSight dashboards
AI	Content generation/rewrite; used inside email editor	Lev AI (compose/rewrite/translate), Universal AI Assistant (agentic support), AI blog, AI Tagging Game

2. Feature tree

2.1 Agency Revolution feature tree

- **Email marketing**
 - Email creation
 - Block-based drag-drop editor (text, image, button, video, divider)
 - Per-location / per-brand sender configuration
 - Reusable agency branding (logo, footer, signature)
 - Grammarly integration in composer (agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
 - AI content creation / rewrite (tone + length) (Agency Revolution)
 - Merge fields: primary contact, secondary contact, policy, carrier, rate-change % (agencyrevolution)
 - Dynamic content via Segment Match filters (not per-block dynamic content) ([INFERRED])
 - Email types
 - Broadcast (one-off send) (agencyrevolution)
 - Campaign sequence steps (automated)

- Postcard step as alternative channel (agencyrevolution)
- Deliverability & compliance
 - Custom domain + DMARC verification required for sender (Agencyrevolution)
(agencyrevolution)
 - Shared sending infrastructure ([INFERRED: FMG-operated ESP])
 - Auto-generated unsubscribe link; CAN-SPAM + CASL compliant
(agencyrevolution)
 - Invalid-email notification campaign built in (agencyrevolution) (Agencyrevolution)
 - "Unable to Email" & "Email Gathering" hygiene campaigns
(agencyrevolution +2)
- Testing
 - Outbox approval queue (preview & approve pending messages before release) — primary QA mechanism (agencyrevolution + 2)
 - Send test to self ([INFERRED]) (Agencyrevolution)
 - **No documented A/B testing**
- **SMS marketing ("Business Texting")**
 - Channels: 1:1 threads, bulk texts (from Campaign sequence only — not from Broadcasts) (agencyrevolution +2)
 - Two-way browser inbox
 - Web chat widget (Forge integration) (Agency Revolution +3)
 - Phone number: port existing or provision new (Agency Revolution +3)
 - MMS ([INFERRED supported])
 - Compliance: 10DLC brand/campaign registration managed by FMG; TOS-enforced opt-in; STOP keyword handling (Agencyrevolution + 2)
 - Merge fields match email
- **CRM / contact system**
 - Hierarchy: Account → Contact(s) → Policy(ies)

- Policy fields: Policy ID, Policy Number, Status (Active/Quoted/Renewed/Reinstated/Canceled), Effective/Expiration dates, Premium, Future Premium, Line of Business, Producer, CSR (Agencyrevolution + 4)
- Tags ("Tagging Accounts from Statistics Views") (Agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
- Account Segments (100+ data points, custom criteria) (Agency Revolution + 2)
- Pipeline (Kanban): stages, My Day view, CSV lead import (agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
- Activity timeline per account (sent/opened/bounced, form submissions, NPS)
- Two-way writeback (HawkSoft confirmed; activities posted as AMS notes) (PR Newswire)
- **Automation engine**
 - Structure: Campaign → Sequence(s) → Step(s)
 - Step types: Email, SMS, Postcard, Internal Notification, Wait, Zapier Zap
 - Trigger Points
 - Account events: New Customer, New Bound Customer, Lost Customer, New Prospect, Reinstated Customer (Agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
 - Policy events: Each New Policy, First New Policy, Additional Policy, Lost Policy, Renewed Policy, New Quoted Policy, **Policy Premium Rate Change** (% threshold) (Agencyrevolution + 3)
 - Date-based: X-date / renewal offset (e.g., 30/60/90 days prior)
 - Behavior: form submission, limited email open/click, NPS response
 - External: Zapier
 - Branching/if-else: via Segment Match entry/exit filters (no visual branch nodes)
 - Multi-channel: email + SMS + postcard + notification in one sequence
 - Exit rules: segment removal, purchase-of-cross-sold-policy removal, pause (Agency Revolution)
 - 2026 update: "Flexible sequence launch" — activate some sequences within a campaign while keeping others paused (Agency Revolution)

- **Campaign library (100+ campaigns)**
 - Welcome: Personal / Commercial Welcome Kits (agencyrevolution +2)
 - Cross-sell: Auto↔Home, Personal→Umbrella, Personal→Life, Commercial→Personal, Commercial→Workers Comp, High Net Worth (Clickable Coverage) (Agencyrevolution + 3)
 - Renewal: X-date nurture driven by policy data; Premium-Rate-Change Renewal sequence
 - Account Reviews: Personal + Commercial (agencyrevolution +2)
 - Retention: Lost Customer Winback (agencyrevolution +2)
 - Claims: Claims follow-up, Disaster Preparedness broadcast (agencyrevolution)
 - Referrals / Reviews: NPS Campaign, Google review request, Reputation Management sequences (Agencyrevolution)
 - Newsletters: Monthly, Medicare quarterly, local "Neighboring"
 - Milestones: Primary + Secondary Contact Birthday (agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
 - Holidays: 2026 15-email series, postcards (Changelog)
 - Data hygiene: Email Gathering, Invalid Email, Unable to Email (agencyrevolution +2)
 - Niche: Cyber Liability, New Business Homeowners Pipeline (Agencyrevolution) (agencyrevolution)
- **Reporting**
 - Unified AR Workspace dashboard (Agencyrevolution +2)
 - Email: open rate, engagement score (composite), sent/opened/bounced (Agency Revolution +2)
 - NPS: 1-10 scoring, promoter/passive/detractor segmentation, per-employee NPS, export (Agencyrevolution + 2)
 - Business Insights: book of business, active customers, policies in force, premium, producer performance; Health/Financial toggles (Agency Revolution) (agencyrevolution)
 - Marketing Analytics cross-campaign view (agencyrevolution)

- Marketing Calendar (2026): scheduled/sent comms visualization agencyrevolution
Changelog
- Attribution: policy/revenue correlated to campaign touches via AMS linkage

2.2 Levitate feature tree

- **Email marketing**
 - Email creation
 - Plain-text "personal" emails (primary flow — discourages HTML/graphics/links)
 - HTML Newsletter tab (added Aug 2025) — separate surface Levitate
 - Merge tokens incl. AMS-synced fields
 - Nickname substitution ("Bob" for "Robert") Levitate +3
 - Lev AI Assistant: compose, rewrite tone, translate to 10 languages levitate
Levitate
 - Custom templates: 4/year included in all plans Levitate Levitate
 - Sending architecture
 - OAuth to user's Gmail / Outlook / Microsoft 365 / Exchange
 - Emails originate from user's own mailbox → inherits sender reputation
Levitate
 - Subject to Gmail/Outlook daily send quotas (sending can span days/weeks)
Software Advice
 - Auto-exclusion: deceased, unsubscribed, "Email Bounced" tag Levitate +2
 - Testing / compliance
 - Tagging Game for list hygiene; AI mode suggests tags from 2 years of subject lines Levitate
 - Unsubscribe handled via tag + suppression
 - No documented A/B testing; no documented send-time optimization

- **SMS**
 - 1:1 threads + "text campaigns" (each sent singly — not a true group blast)
 - Two-way inbox (web + mobile)
 - Shared number across the agency (Levitate)
 - MMS: ≤1.7 MB/attachment, ≤3.5 MB total; URLs sent as plain text (no hyperlinks) (Levitate) (Levitate)
 - Limits: 1,000 messages/day/account; Sole Proprietors 50/hour & 15/minute (Levitate)
 - 10DLC registration handled via Success Specialist (Levitate)
 - Opt-out: STOP keyword (carrier-mandated)
 - Financial-vertical compliance archiving (Levitate)
- **CRM / contact**
 - Keep in Touch cadence per contact (e.g., every 30d); auto-resets on send (Levitate)
 - Tags: colored, Tag Categories, Tag Logic (AND/OR)
 - Auto-applied tags: "Imported On: <date>," "Email Bounced," "Unsubscribe," Line of Business, Carrier, Client/Past Client/Prospect (Levitate +2)
 - Key Facts: date-based (anniversary, renewal) or informational ("twin girls") (Levitate)
 - Action Items: tasks (private option, calendar sync) (Levitate)
 - Policy Boards: searchable policy UI (LOB, carrier, owner, date range) (Levitate)
 - Household grouping: by email or first+last name (limitation: one email per contact) (Levitate)
 - Meeting scheduler: 30/60/custom durations, daily/monthly caps, mandatory comments
 - Calendar sync: Outlook, Exchange, Gmail, Redtail (Levitate)
- **Automation engine**
 - Multi-step, multi-channel (email + text + handwritten card + tag add/remove + action item) (Levitate) (Levitate)

- Triggers: date-based (birthday, renewal, "Turning XX"), tag-based, integration events, contact-creation (Levitate) (levitate)
- Segments within automations (e.g., Homeowner-but-no-Auto) (Levitate)
- Step controls: cancel if criteria no longer met; override sender per step; stop on reply; tag-on-click (Levitate)
- YOLO mode: fully automated, no approval (Levitate)
- Date triggers run nightly (~24-48h lag documented) (Levitate)
- **AI surface**
 - Lev AI (compose/rewrite/translate)
 - Universal AI Assistant (agentic in-app: answers support Qs, pulls contact lists by criteria, reports account stats)
 - AI social posts
 - AI blog (unlimited GPT-created blog content — Advanced/Prestige) (Valuecore)
 - AI Tagging Game (segmentation)
 - AI-suggested Google review replies
 - Custom GPT per agency
- **Campaign library**
 - Award-winning pre-written monthly content tailored by industry (Levitate)
 - Drag-drop content calendar (schedule months ahead) (Levitate)
 - Pre-built automations: birthday, renewal, milestone ("Turning XX"), new-client welcome, meeting reminder, donor, reviews, post-policy onboarding
 - Social media template library
- **Reporting**
 - Dashboard cards (birthday/renewal reminders, action items, nudges, satisfaction, Google reviews) (Levitate)
 - Email: opens, clicks, replies (real-time notifications) (g2) (Real Magic)
 - Client Happiness Score™ (NPS-style)

- Opportunity Boards + advanced reports via QuickSight Levitate
- Tag + automation reports
- Export limitations (reviewer-confirmed weak) Software Advice Software Advice

3. Insurance-specific capabilities

3.1 Policy lifecycle trigger matrix

Lifecycle event	Agency Revolution	Levitate
New prospect / lead	New Prospect trigger (not on HawkSoft — must simulate via segment) agencyrevolution	Contact-creation trigger + tag auto-apply
Quote generated	New Quoted Policy (not on QQCatalyst, Xanatek, EZLynx) agencyrevolution	[INFERRED: limited; not first-class – may come via AMS tag/key-fact sync]
Policy bound / new business	New Bound Customer , First New Policy , Each New Policy , Additional Policy agencyrevolution	New Client integration event; tag-driven welcome automation
Onboarding	Personal/Commercial Welcome Kits agencyrevolution	Post-policy onboarding automation (prebuilt) Software Advice
Endorsement	[INFERRED not a first-class trigger; captured via AMS]	[INFERRED via AMS sync tag changes]

Lifecycle event	Agency Revolution	Levitare
	policy update]	
Renewal upcoming (30/60/90d)	X-date offset triggers; Policy Premium Rate Change at renewal with % threshold	Date-based renewal trigger (key-fact driven), Key Fact renewal reminders on dashboard
Renewal completed	Renewed Policy (not on Partner Platform, NASA Eclipse, PowerBroker) Agencyrevolution	[INFERRED: tag-driven via AMS sync]
Cross-sell (mono-line detected)	Segment + Cross-sell Campaign templates; auto-exit on cross-sell purchase Agency Revolution	Segment-within-automation (e.g., Homeowner renewal but no Auto) Levitare
Claim filed / closed	Claims follow-up campaign (manual or via event trigger)	[INFERRED: manual or via AMS activity]
Policy cancelled / lapsed	Lost Customer, Lost Policy; buffered ~3 weeks to avoid false positives Agencyrevolution agencyrevolution	Tag-driven winback [INFERRED]
Birthday / anniversary	Primary + Secondary contact birthday campaigns agencyrevolution	Birthday automation; Key-Fact-driven milestone automations
Life events (new driver, new home)	Segment-driven; manual	Key Fact captures + manual

3.2 AMS integration matrix

AMS	AR support	Levitate support	Sync style	Directionality
Applied Epic	✓ native	✗ gap (not listed)	API	AR: primarily read, writeback varies
Applied TAM	✓	✗	API	Read-primarily
EZLynx (Applied)	✓ email-report/CSV	✓ email-report/CSV	Scheduled-report ingest	Read-only (both); no writeback (Catalyit)
Vertafore AMS360	✓ native (flagship) (Agency Revolution) (Vertafore)	✓	API nightly	Read (+ limited write) (Levitate)
Vertafore QQCatalyst	✓ (no Quoted trigger)	✓	API nightly	Read
Vertafore Sagitta	[INFERRED: via Epic/TAM adjacency or not supported]	✗	—	—
HawkSoft	✓ V2 API, two-way (2022+) — writes sent/opened/bounced	✓ bi-directional writebacks (notes/emails/texts/calls); (Levitate) but Client Tags	API	Bi-directional

AMS	AR support	Levitate support	Sync style	Directionality
	back as activities MarTech Cube	not exposed via API Levitate		
Nowcerts	✓	✗ gap	API [INFERRED]	Read
Xanatek (IMS)	✓ two-way (2025/2026) Changelog	✓	API	Bi-directional (AR)
NASA Eclipse	✓ (no Renewed Policy trigger)	✓	API	Read
Partner Platform	✓ (no Renewed Policy trigger)	✗	API	Read
PowerBroker	✓ (no Renewed Policy trigger)	✗	API	Read
AgencyZoom	Via Zapier / Forge agencyrevolution Agencyrevolution	✗	—	—
Veruna	Forge integration	✗	—	—
Wealthbox / Redtail (wealth)	✗	✓ (twice-daily sync, custom fields→tags/key facts; writeback optional)	API	Bi-directional

AMS	AR support	Levitate support	Sync style	Directionality
Clio Manage / MyCase / PracticePanther (legal)	✗	✓	API	Bi-directional (Clio)

Data pulled (field-level, both platforms, intersection): contact first/last name, email (Levitate: primary only — hard gap), phone, mailing address, household/account ID, DOB/birthday, producer/CSR assignment, "Do Not Market" flag, policy number, policy status, line of business, carrier, effective + expiration (X-date) dates, premium, future premium (AR), rate-change % (AR on AMS360/Epic), policy-level coverage metadata ([INFERRED limited]). Claims and commission data **not pulled** by either platform in public docs. (Levitate)

Sync frequency: Both are nightly-batch dominant. Real-time/webhook triggers are not documented — a material limitation for time-sensitive workflows (e.g., "text within 5 minutes of quote"). AR explicitly suppresses event firing during initial backfill; Levitate's date triggers have a 24-48h lag. (Agencyrevolution + 2)

4. Automation engine deconstruction

4.1 Trigger taxonomy

Category	AR	Levitate
Time-based	Policy date offsets (X-date $\pm$ N days); recurring date (birthday, anniversary); scheduled broadcast	Date-based (birthday, renewal, Turning XX); (Levitate) scheduled campaigns

Category	AR	Levitate
Event-based	AMS policy events (New/Lost/Renewed/Quoted/Additional/Rate Change), new prospect, form submit, NPS response, Zapier	AMS integration events (new client, new donation), contact creation, tag-apply (Levitate)
Behavior-based	Limited email open/click (step-level tag), form submit	Open/click tag-apply on step; (Levitate) stop-on- reply
Manual	Pipeline stage change (manual), broadcast	Manual campaign send, manual automation start
Segment/rule	Segment Match (entry/exit criteria on 100+ data points) (TechnologyCounter)	Segment within automation + tag-logic filters (Levitate)
External	Zapier step	Zapier, API (Advanced/Prestige)

4.2 Workflow builder

- **AR:** linear **Campaign → Sequence → Step** model, not a visual canvas. Branching is expressed as separate sequences keyed off Segment Match filters rather than in-canvas if/else nodes. Strength: deterministic, safe, approval-gated. Weakness: complex branching (e.g., "if opened A and ignored B, then send C else D") requires stringing multiple sequences and segments. (Agencyrevolution)
- **Levitate:** multi-step automation with **per-segment content blocks inside a single automation**, effectively inline branching at the step level. Simpler but less expressive than a full canvas. "Cancel if criteria no longer met" gives clean exit semantics. YOLO vs approval modes are toggled at automation level.

4.3 Execution logic

- **Delays / waits:** AR supports explicit Wait steps and date-anchored steps (N days before/after renewal). Levitate uses calendar-anchored scheduling; delays expressed as offsets from date triggers. (Agencyrevolution)
 - **Multi-channel orchestration:** Both support mixing email + SMS in one automation. AR adds postcard and internal notification. Levitate adds handwritten card (physical mail, \$4-\$5 each) and tag/action-item side-effects.
 - **Concurrency / re-entry:** AR prevents re-entry during an active sequence ([INFERRED]); Outbox queue serializes sends. Levitate's cadence auto-resets on touch (email within window suppresses cadence).
 - **Approval gate:** AR Outbox (preview, approve, cancel individually or in bulk; daily reminder email) is the architectural lynchpin for compliance-sensitive P&C agencies. Levitate offers equivalent via non-YOLO mode; YOLO is opt-in auto-send. (Agencyrevolution)
 - **Backfill safety:** AR suppresses triggers during initial sync — correctly avoids firing "New Customer" campaigns to every existing client on day one. Essential pattern for any successor platform. (Agencyrevolution)
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5. Data model

5.1 Inferred schema (unified across both platforms)

Account / Household (AR explicit; Levitate via email-or-name matching)

- Required: (account_id), (account_type) (personal/commercial), (ams_source_id), (producer_id), (csr_id)
- Optional: (household_address), (customer_since), (segment_tags[]), (book_value_premium), (do_not_market)

Contact

- Required: `contact_id`, `account_id` (FK), `first_name`, `last_name`, `role` (primary/secondary/spouse), `email_primary`, `phone_primary`
- Optional: `nickname`, `dob`, `address`, `key_facts[]` (Levitate), `keep_in_touch_interval` (Levitate), `tags[]`, `unsubscribed`, `bounced`, `deceased`, `sms_opt_in_status`, `last_touched_at`
- **Gap to fix in successor:** multi-email support (Levitate limitation), multi-phone with channel-preference, cross-household membership (e.g., business owner who is also personal lines client)

Policy

- Required: `policy_id`, `policy_number`, `account_id` (FK), `line_of_business`, `carrier_id`, `status` (Active/Quoted/Renewed/Reinstated/Canceled/Lost), `effective_date`, `expiration_date` (X-date), `premium`, `producer_id`
- Optional: `future_premium`, `premium_change_pct`, `coverages[]`, `prior_carrier_id`, `bind_date`, `quote_date`, `cancel_reason`, `commission_rate` (gap — not pulled today)

Carrier

- `carrier_id`, `name`, `lob_supported[]`, `preferred_flag`, `approved_marketing_content_refs[]` [gap — neither platform explicitly models]

Agent / Producer / CSR

- `user_id`, `role`, `email_oauth_token` (Levitate), `assigned_accounts[]`, `nps_score`, `signature_html`, `sender_identity_id`

Communication history

- `comm_id`, `contact_id`, `policy_id?`, `channel`
(email/sms/postcard/handwritten/call/note), `direction`, `automation_id?`, `status`
(queued/approved/sent/delivered/opened/clicked/replied/bounced), `timestamp`,
`thread_id` (SMS), `payload_ref`

Campaign / Automation

- `campaign_id`, `name`, `status`, `trigger_type`, `trigger_config` (JSON),
`sequences[]`, `segment_filter_id`, `exit_rules[]`, `approval_mode` (outbox/yolo)

Segment

- `segment_id`, `rule_tree` (AND/OR of atomic predicates on 100+ fields), `dynamic`
(recompute on each run), `tag_output`

Tag

- `tag_id`, `name`, `color`, `category_id`, `auto_applied_rule?`, `is_system` (e.g.,
Unsubscribe, Email Bounced)

Key Fact (Levitate)

- `key_fact_id`, `contact_id`, `type` (date/info), `label`, `value`, `trigger_eligible`
(bool)

5.2 Tagging & segmentation logic

- **AR:** segments are rule-based queries over 100+ synced data points (policy LOB, status, premium, rate change, customer-since, producer, carrier, etc.); tags are lighter labels applied to accounts. Segments drive entry/exit for sequences.

- **Levitate:** tag-first model (colored, categorized, AND/OR logic). System tags: Imported
On: <date>, Email Bounced, Unsubscribe, LOB, Carrier, Client/Past
Client/Prospect. Tags double as trigger criteria and as segmentation.
- **Custom fields:** AR via segment criteria; Levitate via Key Facts (typed: date or info) and custom fields mapped from AMS integrations (e.g., Wealthbox/Clio custom fields → tags or key facts).

6. Campaign library / content strategy

Category	AR prebuilt (explicit)	Levitate prebuilt (explicit)
Welcome / onboarding	Personal Welcome Kit, Commercial Welcome Kit	New-client welcome, post-policy onboarding
Renewal / X-date	Renewal nurture + Rate-Change Renewal	Renewal reminder automation (Key Fact date-driven)
Cross-sell / upsell	Auto↔Home, Personal→Umbrella, Personal→Life, Commercial→Personal, Commercial→Workers Comp, HNW Clickable Coverage	Segment-within-automation (e.g., Homeowner but no Auto)
Retention / winback	Lost Customer Winback	<u>[INFERRED: tag-driven winback]</u>
Claims	Claims follow-up, Disaster Preparedness broadcast	Not explicit
Reviews / referrals	NPS, Google review request, Reputation Management	AI-suggested Google review replies, review-request automation

Category	AR prebuilt (explicit)	Levitate prebuilt (explicit)
Newsletters	Monthly, Medicare quarterly, local "Neighboring"	Monthly curated insurance content, industry blog library
Milestones	Primary + Secondary Contact Birthday	Birthday, Turning XX, anniversary
Holidays	2026 15-email holiday series, holiday postcards	Seasonal/timely content across verticals
Hygiene	Email Gathering, Invalid Email, Unable to Email	Tagging Game (manual + AI)
Niche	Cyber Liability, New Business Homeowners Pipeline	Donor, meeting reminders (non-insurance-anchored)

Customization level: AR is more "plug and play" — templates are fully wired with triggers and merge fields; customization is text/brand only unless the user rebuilds the sequence. Levitate is more "plug and personalize" — content is written in a personal voice and users are expected to edit for authenticity; Levitate includes 4 custom templates/year per plan for fully bespoke work.

7. Email + SMS UX / workflow

7.1 Agency Revolution — "send a renewal campaign"

1. **Trigger selection:** User opens Campaigns → chooses "Renewal Reminder" template (or creates custom) and binds to Trigger Point Renewed Policy or date offset from expiration_date.

2. **Audience filter:** Segment Match applied (e.g., `line_of_business = Auto AND status = Active AND producer = X`).
3. **Sequence steps:** User sees linear step list (Email 30d prior, SMS 14d prior, Postcard 7d prior, Internal Notification to producer at 5d).
4. **Content binding:** Each step pulls from email template library; merge fields auto-populate from AMS-synced policy data (number, premium, carrier, rate-change %).
5. **Approval gate:** Outbox receives queued messages; CSR reviews and approves individually or in bulk. Cancellation available per-message.
6. **Send:** Messages released; outcomes (sent/opened/clicked/bounced) post to activity timeline and (on HawkSoft) back to AMS as activities.
7. **Attribution:** Policy renewal completion (from AMS nightly sync) correlates to campaign touches within the attribution window.

7.2 Levitate — "keep in touch with renewing homeowners"

1. **Automation build:** Admin creates automation with date trigger on `Renewal Date` key fact, offset -30d.
2. **Segment inside automation:** Filter `Tag: Homeowner AND NOT Tag: Auto` to target cross-sell subset.
3. **Steps:** Step 1 plain-text personal email from producer's Gmail OAuth mailbox; Step 2 handwritten card (14 days later, \$4-\$5); Step 3 text campaign (7 days later); Step 4 Action Item to producer.
4. **Content:** Lev AI drafts the email; user edits in their voice; handwritten card uses handwriting-style font + Forever Stamp via USPS; text kept short (MMS ≤3.5 MB).
5. **Send mechanics:** Emails queued and trickled through producer's mailbox subject to Gmail/Outlook daily limits (may span days). Contact auto-excluded if deceased/unsubscribed/bounced.
6. **Cadence reset:** On contact reply or any outbound touch, Keep-in-Touch interval resets — cadence reminder suppressed.

7. **Reporting:** Opens/clicks/replies on dashboard cards; producer sees real-time open notifications.

7.3 Drip campaign + broadcast UX

- **AR broadcast:** standalone editor, WYSIWYG, segment picker, schedule or send-now, Outbox approval for compliance-sensitive lists. **SMS cannot run in Broadcasts — Campaign sequences only.**
- **Levitate broadcast:** compose in plain text or HTML newsletter tab, apply tag-logic audience, schedule on calendar, send via user inbox.

8. Reporting + analytics

Metric	AR	Levitate
Email opens/clicks	✓ dashboard + per-campaign	✓ dashboard + real-time notification
Email bounces	✓	✓ (auto-tags "Email Bounced")
Reply tracking	[INFERRED limited]	✓ (mailbox-native)
SMS delivery/reply	✓ Business Texting panel [INFERRED basic]	✓ two-way inbox
Engagement score	✓ composite	✓ Client Happiness Score™
NPS / CSAT	✓ full workflow, per-employee	✓ satisfaction surveys driving Happiness Score

Metric	AR	Levitte
Business / book-of-business	✅ Business Insights (policies in force, premium, producer perf)	Opportunity Boards + QuickSight
Campaign-level aggregates	✅ Marketing Analytics	Weak (reviewer complaint: "exporting a report is disappointing")
List health metrics	✅ hygiene campaigns + metrics	❌ limited exports
Revenue attribution	Partial (policy sale correlates to campaign touch via AMS; not a native attribution model)	Not surfaced
Policy-level attribution	Correlation via AMS sync window	Not native
Paid-ad attribution	❌	❌

Both platforms **fall short on revenue/policy attribution** — the metric agencies most want. Neither exposes a first-class "policies influenced / premium attributable" model with configurable lookback windows, multi-touch weighting, or producer-level rollups. This is the single largest analytics opportunity.

9. Limitations / gaps

Agency Revolution

- No visual branching automation canvas; complex if/else requires sequence gymnastics via segments
- No documented A/B testing for email or SMS

- Nightly-batch sync means no near-real-time triggers (e.g., text within minutes of quote)
- EZLynx integration is email-report/CSV based; a failed scheduled report halts sync
- Trigger gaps by AMS: New Prospect (HawkSoft), New Quoted Policy (QQCatalyst/Xanatek/EZLynx), Renewed Policy (Partner Platform, NASA Eclipse, PowerBroker)
- Lost Customer requires ~3-week buffer to avoid false positives
- Pricing opacity + contract-cancellation complaints (B12 review)
- Templated output "feels cookie-cutter" (employee review signal)
- Review presence is thin (G2/Capterra near-empty) — credibility signal
- Time-zone changes force full re-scheduling of queued messages
- SMS unavailable in Broadcasts (only Campaigns)
- No native revenue attribution model

Levitate

- Automation depth: "takes longer to create than it should"; segmentation clunky for insurance (coverage type + renewal cross-filter)
- Gmail/Outlook send quotas throttle large lists — big sends span days/weeks
- SMS: 1,000/day cap, MMS size limits, links rendered as plain text (no clickable URLs), images distort, "fails more than it delivers"
- No multi-email per contact; household combines husband+wife awkwardly
- No Applied Epic native integration; no Nowcerts — gaps for larger/modern agencies
- EZLynx writeback not supported
- HawkSoft Client Tags not exposed via API (writeback gap)
- Analytics depth: list health metrics, campaign aggregate exports all weak
- Template design flexibility limited
- Per-seat + texting add-ons push TCO up for growing agencies
- No AI meeting notes, no AI inbox reply suggestions (gap vs general CRMs)

- No revenue/policy attribution
- 5-user cap on base plans; extra seats paid
- Email attachment cap 3 MB
- Can't search within contact profile by non-name fields (e.g., contract #, DOB)

Common gaps (both)

- Revenue / policy-level attribution with configurable lookback
 - A/B testing (subject line, content, send time)
 - Real-time event triggers (webhooks vs nightly batch)
 - Carrier-approved content libraries / compliance review workflow
 - Lead capture forms → landing pages tied to paid-ad attribution
 - Commission/earnings tracking tied to campaign outcomes
 - Deep claims workflow (claim filed → closed → satisfaction)
 - Rich quote integration (quote-to-bind nurture with real comparative rater data)
 - Conversational AI for inbound (web chat + SMS bot with AMS context)
 - Voice/calling with recording and transcription
 - Video messaging (Loom-style producer video intros)
-

10. Differentiation opportunities

Prioritized by customer value (CV: 1-5), engineering complexity (EC: 1-5), strategic differentiation (SD: 1-5).

#	Opportunity	CV	EC	SD	Why it matters
1	Policy-level revenue attribution with producer rollups, multi-touch, configurable lookback, carrier-level ROI	5	3	5	Agencies cannot prove ROI on either platform today; biggest buying trigger
2	Real-time event bus (AMS webhooks + polling fallback) enabling sub-minute triggers (quote → text)	5	4	5	Neither competitor has this; closes speed-to-lead gap
3	Visual branching workflow canvas with if/else, wait-until-condition, goal nodes, A/B splits	5	4	4	AR has no canvas; Levitate has limited segments — both behind general automation tools
4	Hybrid sending architecture: choose per-send between user-mailbox (Levitate-style deliverability) and managed ESP (AR-style scale) with automatic quota management	5	4	5	Solves Levitate's throttling + AR's generic-sender deliverability in one product
5	Agentic inbox copilot: drafts replies, schedules follow-ups, pulls AMS context, proposes cross-sell at reply-time	5	4	5	Levitate started here with Universal AI Assistant; go deeper
6	Carrier-approved content library with compliance review workflow (E&O safe, carrier brand-safe)	4	3	4	Unaddressed niche pain for captive-adjacent independents
7	Quote-to-bind nurture integrated with comparative raters (PL Rating, EZLynx Rater, Turbo Rater)	5	4	4	Neither integrates quote engines deeply — high-intent moment currently missed

#	Opportunity	CV	EC	SD	Why it matters
8	Native A/B and multivariate testing across subject line, body, send time, channel	4	2	3	Table-stakes in general MA, absent in both
9	Lead capture + landing pages + paid-ad attribution (Facebook/Google Lead Forms → sequence → bound policy ROI)	5	3	4	AR has Forms; no attribution closure; Levitate weaker still
10	Commission-aware campaign ROI: factor carrier commission % into revenue attribution	4	3	5	Unique to insurance; neither platform models commission
11	Household-aware orchestration: cross- policy, cross-contact frequency capping + coordinated messaging (don't text spouse and primary same day)	5	3	4	Both platforms have primitive household models; embarrasses agencies today
12	Multi-email, multi-phone, channel- preference contact model	4	2	3	Fixes Levitate's explicit limitation; AR partially ahead
13	Claims experience loop: filed → closed → CSAT → review/referral request	4	3	4	Under-developed in both
14	Video messaging (async Loom-style producer intros with AMS-data- personalized cards)	3	3	4	Differentiator in a plain-text + graphic-card world
15	Voice/calling + AI transcription with auto-logged notes, sentiment tagging, follow-up tasks	4	4	4	Levitate explicitly doesn't support calling

#	Opportunity	CV	EC	SD	Why it matters
16	Conversational AI on web chat + SMS with AMS context, quote intent detection, producer handoff	5	5	5	Open market across vertical SaaS
17	Carrier content marketplace + co-op funding tracker (carriers reimburse agency marketing — Levitate confirms this exists ad hoc)	4	3	5	Turn carrier dollars into product moat
18	Revenue-loss early warning: ML-flagged at-risk accounts (rate change + service gap + low engagement)	5	4	5	Reframes retention as a scoring product
19	Producer coaching layer: benchmark cadence, response times, cross-sell ratios — nudges producers in-app	3	3	4	Differentiator for principals/managers
20	Deep AMS write-back standard (notes, activities, tasks, policy fields) across Epic, AMS360, HawkSoft, EZLynx, Nowcerts	5	5	5	Both have patchy bi-directional support; winning this is defensible

11. User stories (engineering-ready)

US-01 Renewal nurture trigger

- As an insurance agent, I want automated renewal outreach to fire 30/14/7 days before a policy's expiration date, so that I retain clients without manual monitoring.
- Acceptance: trigger fires from `policy.expiration_date - offset`; supports email + SMS + handwritten card steps; skips deceased/unsubscribed/bounced; approval gate

optional.

- Edge cases: policy renewed early (auto-exit); expiration_date updated post-schedule (reschedule); backfill mode must suppress.
- Dependencies: AMS sync (policy table), message template engine, scheduling service, suppression service.

US-02 Premium rate-change alert

- As a producer, I want a sequence to fire when a renewing policy's premium increases by >X%, so that I proactively address sticker shock.
- Acceptance: threshold configurable per campaign; merge field `premium_change_pct` renders in email; sequence suppresses if account is already in a Lost Customer flow.
- Edge cases: downward change also configurable; rate change detected only at renewal.
- Dependencies: AMS fields `premium`, `future_premium`; segment engine.

US-03 Monoline cross-sell

- As an agent, I want clients with Home but no Auto to enter a cross-sell sequence 90 days after bind, so that I grow policies-per-household.
- Acceptance: segment `has_home AND NOT has_auto`; auto-exit when Auto policy added; respects household-level frequency caps.
- Edge cases: household has Auto on spouse's account — treat as bundled.
- Dependencies: household model, policy inventory per account, frequency cap service.

US-04 Outbox approval

- As a CSR, I want to review queued outbound messages before they send, so that I prevent mistakes.
- Acceptance: preview with merge fields rendered; approve/cancel per-message or bulk; daily summary email; approver audit log.

- Edge cases: approval window exceeded (auto-cancel vs escalate — configurable); approver OOO.
- Dependencies: messaging queue, role/permissions, audit log.

US-05 Hybrid sending

- As an agent, I want to send personal emails from my own Gmail/Outlook and broadcast emails from the managed domain, so that I balance deliverability and scale.
- Acceptance: per-template sender-type choice; OAuth flow for mailbox; quota-aware scheduling that spans days if needed; DMARC/DKIM configured on managed domain.
- Edge cases: OAuth revoked mid-send (pause + notify); quota exhausted (reroute or pause).
- Dependencies: ESP, OAuth service, quota tracker, sender-identity service.

US-06 Policy-level attribution

- As an agency principal, I want to see which campaigns drove which policy outcomes (bound/renewed/cross-sold) with commission impact, so that I justify marketing spend.
- Acceptance: configurable lookback (e.g., 30d); multi-touch weighting (linear, time-decay); producer + carrier rollups; export.
- Edge cases: policy bound outside platform — allow manual attribution tag.
- Dependencies: AMS policy outcome events, communication history, attribution service.

US-07 Keep-in-Touch cadence

- As a producer, I want to be reminded to reach out when I haven't contacted a client in N days, so that I maintain relationships.
- Acceptance: per-contact interval configurable; resets on any outbound touch from producer; tag-group-level intervals supported; surfaces on dashboard.

- Edge cases: client replies via SMS (resets); producer on vacation (pause).
- Dependencies: communication history, reminder service, calendar.

US-08 Lost customer winback with buffer

- As an agent, I want Lost Customer triggers to suppress for ~3 weeks after AMS marks a policy lost, so that I don't send winback to a client whose renewal is just delayed.
- Acceptance: configurable grace period; auto-cancel if policy Reinstated during grace.
- Edge cases: reinstated after grace — treat as new Bound Customer.
- Dependencies: AMS status events, delayed-job queue.

US-09 Carrier-approved content

- As a compliance officer, I want a content library of carrier-approved templates, so that agents cannot send non-approved claims about coverage.
- Acceptance: template tagged by carrier + LOB + approval expiration; unapproved templates blocked per agent's carrier appointments.
- Dependencies: carrier table, appointments, approval workflow.

US-10 Real-time quote trigger

- As a producer, I want a text message sent within 5 minutes of a quote being generated in my rater, so that I capitalize on intent.
- Acceptance: webhook or sub-5-minute polling; SMS step with 10DLC-registered number; compliance check on opt-in.
- Dependencies: rater/AMS webhook ingestion, event bus, SMS service, opt-in ledger.

US-11 Household frequency cap

- As an agency, I want to prevent more than N messages per household per week across all channels, so that we don't over-communicate.

- Acceptance: cap configurable; cross-channel (email + SMS + postcard counted); cross-producer coordination.
- Dependencies: household model, messaging ledger, rate limiter.

US-12 AI draft from AMS context

- As a producer, I want the AI assistant to draft a personal email using the client's policy, last-contact date, and key facts, so that I save time.
- Acceptance: prompt pulls contact + policy + last 5 comms; output in producer voice; human edit before send (non-YOLO).
- Dependencies: LLM service, context retrieval, PII handling.

US-13 SMS compliance ledger

- As a compliance officer, I want every SMS recipient's opt-in source, timestamp, and keyword history logged, so that we satisfy TCPA audits.
- Acceptance: immutable ledger; STOP/HELP handling auto-logged; 10DLC brand/campaign association recorded.
- Dependencies: SMS gateway, ledger service, audit export.

US-14 Segment builder

- As a marketer, I want to build segments with AND/OR logic across contact, policy, and behavior fields, so that I target precisely.
- Acceptance: 100+ predicates; live count; dynamic recompute; tag output optional.
- Edge cases: segment size crosses quota (warn); segment depends on deleted field (validate).
- Dependencies: query engine, fields catalog.

US-15 Claims loop

- As an agent, I want claims-filed and claims-closed events to auto-trigger check-in + CSAT + review-request sequences, so that I turn claims into referrals.
 - Acceptance: event source configurable (AMS claims module or manual entry); CSAT score feeds engagement model.
 - Dependencies: claims event ingestion, survey engine.
-

12. Engineering system design implications

12.1 Component architecture

Data ingestion layer (AMS integrations)

- Connector framework: per-AMS adapter (Epic, AMS360, QQCatalyst, HawkSoft V2 API, EZLynx email-report ingest, Nowcerts, Xanatek, NASA Eclipse, Partner Platform, PowerBroker, Wealthbox, Redtail, Clio) implementing a common `AMSConnector` interface: `syncBaseline()`, `syncDelta()`, `writeback(event)`.
- Ingest modes: API polling (most), webhook (where available — rare today), email-report CSV ingest (EZLynx). Baseline backfill mode suppresses downstream event emission.
- Canonicalization: AMS-specific payloads → unified schema (Account, Contact, Policy, Carrier, Producer, Activity).
- Change detection: field-level diff to emit `policy.rate_changed`, `policy.lost`, `contact.created` events. EZLynx needs report-failure detection + retry; AR's current failure halts sync — a fixable flaw.
- Writeback: activity/note/task/email-send-outcome reverse sync; per-AMS capability matrix (HawkSoft, Wealthbox, Clio supported; EZLynx read-only).
- **Key challenge:** near-real-time triggers require webhook support where vendors allow, plus a polling-heartbeat that's tight enough (≤ 5 min) for speed-to-lead, while respecting vendor rate limits.

Event bus / trigger system

- Central topic streams: `ams.events`, `behavior.events` (opens/clicks/replies), `time.events` (cron-like date anchors), `user.events` (form submit, Zapier), `compliance.events` (opt-out, bounce).
- Consumers: automation engine, attribution, reporting, notification.
- Delayed-job scheduler (e.g., Temporal or a sidekiq-style + scheduler) for offsets like `X-date - 30d`, `lost_customer + 21d` grace window.
- Backfill safety flag on every event; automations must respect it.

Automation engine

- Workflow DSL: nodes (Step, Wait, Branch, Goal, Exit), connected as DAG. Represent AR's linear sequences and Levitate's segment-inline as special cases of the DAG.
- State machine per enrollment: idempotent transitions, re-entry policy per automation, exit conditions evaluated at each step.
- Approval gate: Outbox queue as a first-class stage; per-message approve/cancel with audit trail; bulk actions.
- Frequency capping: household-level global limiter across automations.

Messaging service

- Multi-channel: email (ESP + user-OAuth mailbox), SMS (10DLC-registered via Twilio/Bandwidth), handwritten card (Lob-style API), postcard (print + mail partner), push (producer notifications).
- Hybrid email: policy chooses ESP vs user-mailbox per template/sender-identity; quota-aware throttling for user-mailbox sends (Gmail 2k/day, Outlook 10k/day typical).
- Deliverability: per-domain DMARC/DKIM/SPF provisioning, warm-up scheduler, bounce classification (hard/soft/spam-complaint) → tag writeback.

- Suppression list: unified across channels + reasons (unsubscribe, bounce, deceased, Do-Not-Market, TCPA opt-out).

Template engine

- Block-based editor with merge tokens; MJML under the hood for responsive email; per-channel variants (email, SMS-text-only, postcard print spec).
- Versioning + carrier approval workflow (new capability).
- AI authoring: LLM integration with RAG over contact + policy + comms history; voice-matching fine-tune per producer (stretch).

Data model store

- Relational primary (Postgres): Account, Contact, Policy, Carrier, Producer, Tag, KeyFact, Campaign, Automation, Enrollment, Message, Activity.
- Segment/search index (Elastic/OpenSearch): fast 100+ predicate filters with live count.
- Time-series (Clickhouse / Druid): campaign metrics, attribution events.
- Ledger (append-only Postgres or Kafka-sourced): communication history, SMS compliance ledger.

Attribution service

- Consumes `ams.policy_bound`, `ams.policy_renewed`, `ams.policy_lost` events and joins against `Message` history within configurable lookback.
- Models: last-touch, linear, time-decay, position-based. Commission-aware revenue calc: `premium × commission_rate(carrier, lob)`.
- Producer + carrier + LOB rollups; cohort analysis.

AI / agent layer

- Compose / rewrite / translate (Lev-parity).

- Universal Assistant: tool-using agent over contact/segment/campaign APIs; pulls contact lists by criteria, answers support, reports stats.
- Agentic features to differentiate: inbox reply copilot, meeting note writer, at-risk account scorer, quote-intent detector on web chat.
- Guardrails: PII redaction in prompts; opt-in per agency for training; compliance filters for state-regulated claims.

Compliance & security

- TCPA/10DLC registration workflow baked in; CAN-SPAM unsubscribe links; CASL (Canada) flags.
- SOC 2 Type 2 parity.
- Per-state regulatory flags on content (e.g., CA, NY, TX specifics for insurance claims language).
- Role-based access: Principal, Producer, CSR, Marketer, Compliance roles with distinct permissions.

12.2 Infrastructure & scale

- Multi-tenant with per-agency isolation for PII.
- Queueing: Temporal (durable workflows for automations) + Kafka (event bus) recommended.
- Scale targets: support $10k \text{ agencies} \times 5k \text{ contacts avg} \times 10 \text{ messages/year/contact} = \sim 500M \text{ messages/year}$; peak daily send windows (Tuesday 10am-ish) drive burst capacity.
- Observability: per-agency metrics, per-automation success/failure dashboards, sync-health monitoring for each AMS connector (EZLynx's fragile email-report ingest demands explicit health checks).
- Disaster recovery: append-only ledgers allow replay; baseline re-sync procedures per AMS.

12.3 Onboarding flow (design implications)

- Current market baseline: AR onboarding 4-6 weeks (+2-3 weeks DIFM); Levitate sales-led with 10DLC registration bottleneck for SMS. Opportunity: **self-serve onboarding with guided AMS connection wizard, baseline sync progress UI, 10DLC registration assistant, and first-campaign-in-15-minutes flow** — a materially superior buyer experience.

12.4 Pricing structure implications

- Both competitors hide pricing (AR ~\$250/mo entry per Capterra listing; DIFM tier unpublished; Levitate custom-quote with per-seat and \$4-\$5/handwritten-card). Implications for a successor:
 - Transparent tiered pricing (agencies hate the sales-call gate).
 - Usage-based add-ons priced in the product: SMS per segment, handwritten cards per unit, AI tokens metered.
 - AMS integration bundled (neither charges per-AMS today — don't break that norm).
 - Carrier co-op reimbursement as a billing feature (split invoices per carrier automatically).

Conclusion

The P&C marketing-automation category has two durable players with complementary strengths and overlapping blind spots. Agency Revolution owns **depth** — event-rich AMS triggers, an approval-gated Outbox, and a 100+ campaign library built for insurance realities. Levitate owns **authenticity and AI** — mailbox-native deliverability, a relationship cadence that feels human, and an agentic assistant already in production. Neither owns what buyers most want next: **real-time triggers, visual branching, hybrid sending,**

household-level orchestration, and hard-number revenue attribution with commission awareness. A successor built on a canonical AMS ingestion layer, a Temporal-backed automation DAG, a hybrid ESP-plus-mailbox sending engine, and an attribution service that speaks policy-premium-and-commission — wrapped in a transparent self-serve experience — would leapfrog both on the dimensions agencies buy on (ROI provable in dollars, speed to first campaign, and real-time responsiveness). The data model is insurance-specific but tractable; the defensibility is in the event bus, the writeback quality, and the compliance-plus-carrier-content fabric that neither incumbent has yet built.